

Soochow University Student Leave Regulations

Passed by the Student Affairs Meeting on March 13, 2024

Revised in the Student Affairs Meeting on April 09, 2025

Article 1: Students requesting leave must adhere to the following guidelines. Absences without completing the leave process will be regarded as unexcused. Calculations and handling of unexcused and excused absences will follow the university's regulations for different educational programs.

Article 2: During the semester, students who are unable to attend classes due to the following reasons may apply for general leave:

1. **Personal Leave:** Due to matters requiring personal handling, with supporting documents.
2. **Sick Leave:** Due to illness requiring treatment or recuperation, with a hospital or clinic diagnosis or other related documentation.
3. **Official Leave:**

Granted in the following situations:

- Required by law to appear in court as a witness, defense participant, or serve as a national juror.
- Participation in national elections, recall votes, referendums, or other official voting activities.

In the following situations, official leave may be granted:

- Selected by a government agency to represent the country in competitions or activities.
- Approved to represent the university or department in official off-campus or intercollegiate activities or competitions.
- Participation in school-wide official activities or competitions hosted by the university.
- Attendance at meetings or performing official duties convened by university administrative units.

- Other situations not mentioned above, upon approval by the department chair on the supporting documents or report, after which the student can apply for leave from the instructor.

4. **Bereavement Leave:** For the death of immediate family members, siblings, or cohabiting relatives for purposes of permanent common living, with an obituary or death certificate.

5. **Maternity Leave:** For pregnancy, including miscarriage (induced or natural), childbirth, or the pregnancy of a spouse or partner, with relevant medical documentation.

6. **Childcare Leave:** For the temporary medical care of children under three without family members available for care, with relevant identification documents for the child.

7. **Marriage Leave:** For the student's marriage, with supporting documents, limited to seven days.

8. **Menstrual Leave:** For difficulty attending classes due to menstruation, limited to two day per month without requiring supporting documents.

9. **Psychological Adjustment Leave:** For psychological or mental discomfort causing difficulty attending classes, limited to one day per request without requiring supporting documents, and up to three days per semester. If leave reaches two days, the advisor will prioritize care; if it reaches three days or more, the Counseling and Health Center will provide proactive care.

10. **Indigenous Cultural Ritual Leave:** For seasonal rituals of indigenous tribes as announced by the Council of Indigenous Peoples, with a copy of household registration, household certificate, or certification issued by a government agency.

For all types of leave mentioned above, completing the leave process before class is a general principle, and leave days will be granted according to actual needs. Official leave must be requested in advance. For other types of leave, if a prior leave application is not possible, it should be completed within one week of the day after absence; for temporary exams or midterms, the arrangement of make-up exams is at the discretion of the course instructor.

Article 3: Marriage leave, menstrual leave, and psychological adjustment leave are requested by the day. Except for single-day menstrual or psychological adjustment leave, which does not require

approval, other types of leave must be approved by the course instructor to complete the leave process.

Article 4: During semester examinations, students who are unable to attend due to the following reasons may apply for leave and a make-up exam:

1. Illness, with supporting hospital documentation indicating inability to attend the exam.
2. Death of immediate family members, siblings, or cohabiting relatives for permanent common living, with supporting documentation.
3. Maternity leave, pregnancy, or sudden childcare needs, with supporting documentation.
4. Disasters, such as earthquakes, fires, floods, etc., causing transportation disruption, with supporting documentation.
5. Transportation delays, with supporting documentation from the transportation provider.
6. Difficulty attending exams due to menstruation, limited to one day, without requiring documentation.
7. Psychological or mental discomfort causing inability to attend exams, with supporting documentation.
8. Other force majeure circumstances, with supporting documentation proving the validity.

The leave application must be submitted within five working days following the exam for which leave is requested, reviewed by the department chair with comments, and approved by the Academic Affairs Office. One make-up exam will be granted, according to the supplementary exam date set in the academic calendar for the semester.

Article 5: If any falsified, fabricated, or altered documentation is found in leave applications, the absence will be treated as unexcused, and disciplinary action will be taken based on the severity of the offense.

Article 6: If students feel that the determination or handling of their leave is inappropriate and affects their attendance rights, they may file an appeal under the Organizational Charter and Operational Guidelines of the Soochow University Student Appeal Review Committee.

Article 7: These regulations take effect upon approval by the Student Affairs Meeting and confirmation by the President. Amendments follow the same process. Once the leave system is established, these regulations will be implemented after approval by the President.